



The Prefixes over- and under-

I can add over- and under- to make new words.

- Today I am learning to:
- ☐ understand what over- and under- mean
 - ☐ add over- and under- to base words
 - ☐ read and use new words
 - ☐ use the words in sentences

1 Learn the Rule

The prefix **over-** means **too much, more than usual or above**.

The prefix **under-** means **too little, less than usual or below**.

When we add a prefix to a base word, we make a new word with a different meaning.

**over- = too much,
more than, above**

**under- = too little,
less than, below**



overflow
water that goes
over the top



overload
too much work



overpass
a road that goes
over another road



underground
below the ground



underfill
not enough



underwear
worn under
clothing

2 Add over- or under-

Write the new word.

1. flow over _____



2. ground under _____



3. cook over _____



4. pay under _____



5. pass over _____



6. estimate under _____



3 Match the Meaning

Draw a line to match each word with its meaning.

overflow	•	•	cook for too long
underestimate	•	•	pay too much
overcook	•	•	below the ground
underground	•	•	not enough clothing
overpay	•	•	more than you think or say
underwear	•	•	water that goes over the top

4 Choose the Correct Word

Tick (✓) the word that makes sense.

- The cup will ☐ overflow ☐ underflow if we keep pouring.
- Plants can grow ☐ overground ☐ underground in the soil.
- I think I ☐ overestimated ☐ underestimated the time.
- Don't ☐ overcook ☐ undercook the vegetables.
- He had to ☐ overpay ☐ underpay for the ticket.
- I need my ☐ overcoat ☐ underwear before I get changed.

5 Use the Words

Write a sentence for each picture using a word with **over-** or **under-**.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Word Bank

overflow underground overcook
underestimate overpay underwear

Challenge

Choose a base word of your own. Add **over-** or **under-** and write a sentence with the new word.

Prefixes help us
be more precise
with our meaning!

